policy-makers and banking professionals who are interested in knowing more about the history of our financial system'—**Dr Bimal Jalan, former Governor, Reserve Bank of India**

'This outstanding book is perhaps the first of its kind, dovetailing as it does the history of five important financial institutions with the contributions of six illustrious personalities. It covers Indian banking history over a period of a century and I am truly amazed at the enormity of the task and the ease with which it has been accomplished by the author. *Barons of Banking* is eminently readable even by a person who is totally unfamiliar with banking and finance. It is a must read for those who are interested in the Indian financial sector and the economy, and value the lessons history has to offer in resolving the current problems faced by the country'—**N. Vaghul, former Chairman, ICICI Limited**

'This is an excellent and well-researched biographical history which while recounting the life and times of some legendary personalities in Indian banking and finance in the last century, brings to life the history and evolution of the institutions of central banking, commercial banking, and India's interaction with international financial institutions. Altogether, an interesting and valuable record of the events of that period and the part played in shaping these events by the leading *dramatis personae*'—**M Narasimham, former Governor, Reserve Bank of India, and Chairman Emeritus, Administrative Staff College of India**

'*Barons of Banking* is a captivating narrative of the evolution of banking in India, spun around the contributions of six legendary institution builders. The contribution of these great doyens of Indian banking is not generally known and this book is a welcome attempt to bridge this gap. Traversing an entire century, the author admirably traces the stellar efforts of these individuals, set against the tribulations and travails of a nation in the making. Peppered with several interesting anecdotes, the book is as much a treatise on institutionbuilding as about the personal struggles of the individuals contributing to the process. I strongly recommend this book to